

GETTY IMAGES



MODI WITH DAUGHTER ALIYA (LEFT),  
WIFE MINAL AND SON RUCHIR

## LIKE MOST AUTOCRATS, MODI TOOK LEAVE FROM THE WORLD OF ACCOUNTABILITY AND TRANSPARENCY AND WITHDREW HIMSELF INTO THE MAKE BELIEVE OF IMMORTALITY.

gilded world of power and glamour. The swagger is missing; he may still sound defiant but the ground is slipping from beneath his designer loafers. The one who is used to the company of A-listers from politics, business and showbiz finds himself staring into a void—alone and abandoned.

In retrospect, his was a journey semaphored by ambition and determination. The story of Modi, a business graduate from Duke University in America, is far from being a rags-to-riches saga; rather, it is one of riches to an embarrassment of riches. Born into a north Indian business family—he is still the managing director of the Rs 4,000-crore Modi Enterprises and executive director of Godfrey Phillips, the country's second largest cigarette manufacturers—he was too driven to be confined to the anonymity of family

business. Inspired by the English Premier League, Modi structured the Indian Premier League as an end-to-end laterally connected business model that integrated investments, entertainers and mass audiences to deliver great revenues. In this he learnt from all the mistakes that the Subhash Chandra-led initiative, Indian Cricket League, had made. That IPL is a \$4 billion-plus brand is a testimony to his execution abilities. Modi claims he first came up with the idea of a league in the 90s when he was distributing ESPN. But the BCCI ignored the arriviste. Modi was not the one to give up. What he wanted most was an entry pass for the hallowed precincts of BCCI—somehow. He found an ally in the then Rajasthan chief minister Vasundhara Raje, who got the rules of election to the Rajasthan Cricket Association (RCA)

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